CHAPTER 5
A Plan

Shah Jahan wanted the tomb of his beloved to overlook the Yamuna River. The owner of the land offered it to Shah Jahan for free. But instead, the Shah gave him a palace.

Even before the plans for the building were completed, work started. Water would be an important part of the tomb area. There would be channels and fountains.

Building near a river presented problems. Part of the year India has a season of heavy rains, called *monsoons*. The building for the tomb had to be protected from flooding. It also had to be kept from sinking into the soft ground.

Hundreds of workers began digging a huge foundation. Shah Jahan wanted it finished as soon as possible. So they worked even in the hottest time of the year. Sometimes the temperature reached 110 degrees Fahrenheit.